

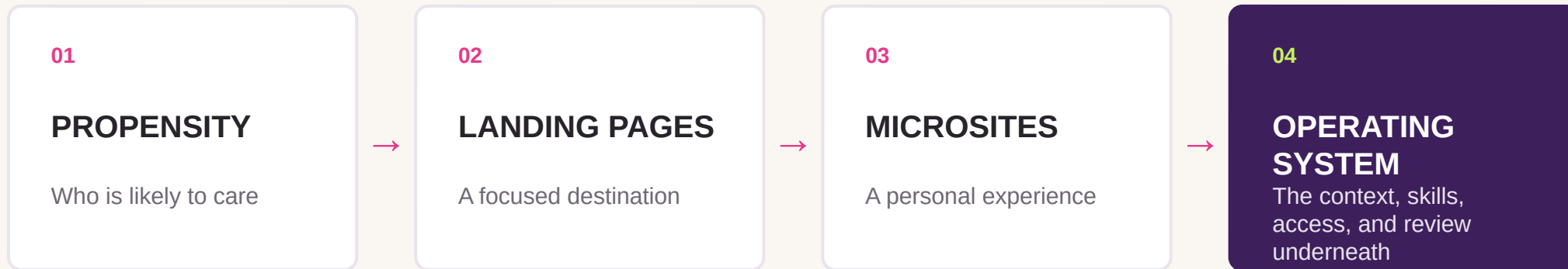
AI for ABM: What You Need to Know About MCPs, Agents & Prompts

TREY HARNDEN | FORGEX

SEPTEMBER 17, 2026 | 12 PM ET | LIVE WORKSPACE BUILD



Part I showed the output. Part II builds the system.



The page was never the whole product. The repeatable system is the real asset.

Nine terms. One operating system.

MODEL

reasons and generates

TOOL

performs a capability

HARNESS

holds files, tools, state, controls

MCP

connects approved resources and tools

PROMPT

directs this request

AUTOMATION

runs a known path

CONTEXT

grounds the work in evidence and rules

AGENT

chooses a path toward a goal

SKILL

standardizes a reusable process

Access is not permission. Fluency starts with knowing which layer owns which decision.

Fluency is observable behavior, not tool familiarity.

CAPABLE

ADOPTIVE

TRANSFORMATIVE

Mindset • Strategy • Building • Accountability

ForgeX adds the ABM infrastructure between a good prompt and a governed outcome.

Zapier's AI Fluency Rubric	
Capable "I use AI to operate at a meaningfully higher level."	Mindset: Has tried multiple AI tools and can describe their growth over 2-3 points in time: what they started with, what they switched to, and why. Strategy: Can explain why they use AI for specific parts of their work and not others, and how it's improved quality, experience, or output, not just speed. Building: Has built repeatable tools or workflows that are embedded into how they do their recurring work. Accountability: Evaluates AI outputs against defined standards and can describe catching and correcting problems before they shipped.
Adoptive "I orchestrate AI and build systems that elevate how I work."	Mindset: Ships experiments quickly and redesigns recurring work based on what they learn. Strategy: Identifies where existing processes should be replaced by AI-native approaches, not just augmented, and can explain the tradeoffs behind those choices. Building: Orchestrates multiple AI tools into durable systems (agents, pipelines, automations) that eliminate meaningful manual work. Accountability: Designs validation and feedback loops into their systems and anticipates failure modes before they happen.
Transformative "I re-engineer how work happens."	Mindset: Continuously experiments at the systems level, testing and discarding approaches to how their team or function works, not just their own tasks. Strategy: Has stopped or replaced legacy work and can articulate what they're betting on instead and why. Building: Has built systems that eliminated entire categories of work or created capabilities that didn't previously exist. Accountability: Embeds governance and quality standards at the team or org level so AI increases quality at scale.
Updated March 2026	
zapier	

Move up one useful level.



Do not jump to Level 5. Earn the context, process, and controls underneath it.

Level 0: Fancy Search

INPUT

Teach me about AI security for manufacturers. Give me five campaign ideas.

OUTPUT

Generalized ideas you still have to sift, verify, and rebuild.

A fluent answer is not an account insight.

LAYER ADDED

Model or search interface

Level 1: Contextual Copilot

INPUT

North Peak sells Discover, Protect, and Monitor. Alder is expanding industrial AI. Draft three campaign premises for a VP of Infrastructure. Separate facts from hypotheses.

OUTPUT

A more relevant one-off draft.

The marketer still knows what to paste, what to ask, and what to correct.

LAYER ADDED

Structured prompt + supplied context + human iteration

Level 2: Grounded Workspace

INPUT

Use the North Peak company brain and Alder evidence pack.
Recommend one campaign premise. Cite the source file for each material claim.

OUTPUT

A grounded draft that uses the same brand, ICP, persona, product, and proof rules every time.

Stop making the model relearn the company.

LAYER ADDED

Persistent, approved context

Build a company brain, not a document dump.

NORTH PEAK / CONTEXT

/brand-guidelines.md

/messaging-framework.md

/icp.md

/personas.md

/product-portfolio.md

/proof-and-claims.md

/source-manifest.md

SCOPED

Only what this job needs

SOURCE-BACKED

Claims retain provenance

FRESH

Owners and review dates

PERMISSION-AWARE

Access follows policy

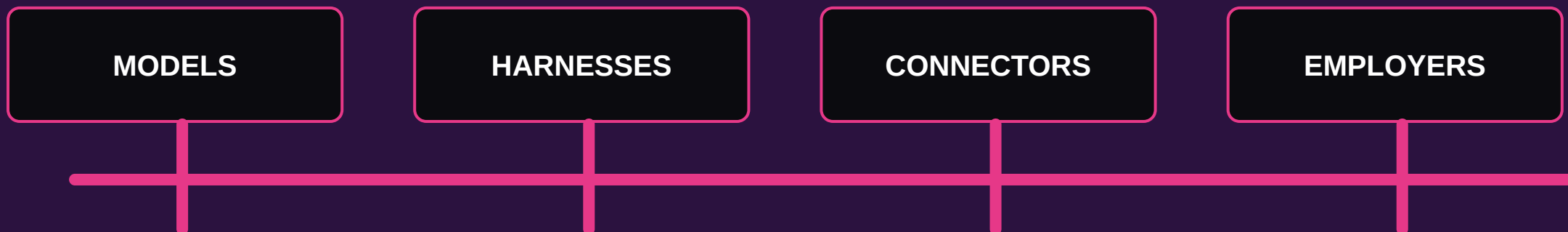
VERSIONED

Changes stay inspectable

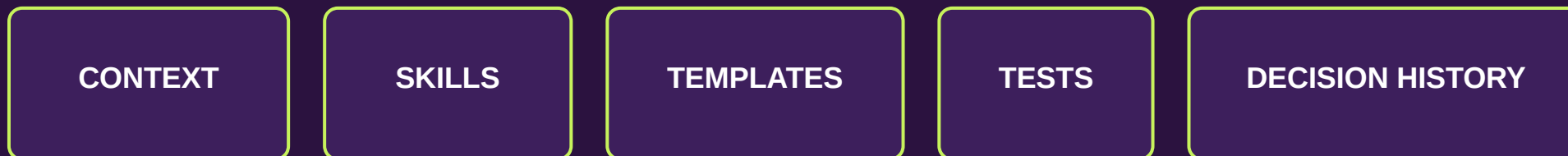
GitHub is one useful pattern. The rule is durable ownership and change history.

Learn the plumbing. Keep the durable parts portable.

THE FIXTURES CHANGE



THE CRAFT COMPOUNDS



Company tools are fixtures. Your ability to reconnect the system is the craft.

Level 3: Reusable Skill

TELL ME X ANSWER



PRODUCE Y OUTCOME
THROUGH THIS PROCESS

INPUT

Follow the ABM Strategist skill. Use the North Peak corpus and Alder evidence. Produce the required campaign brief. Apply the output contract and QA. Stop before creative or outreach.

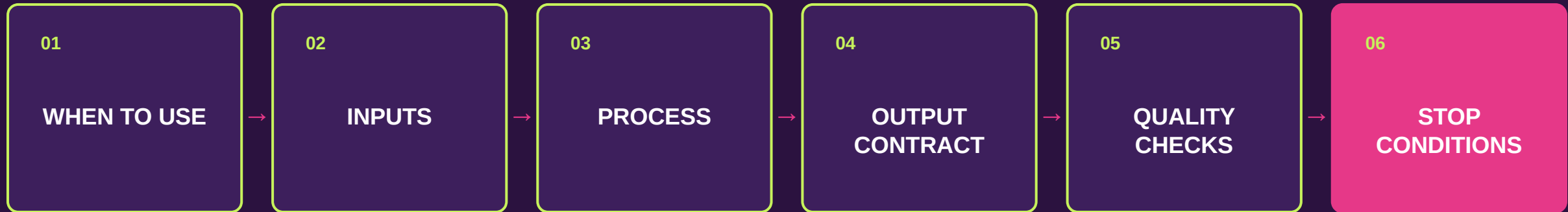
OUTPUT

The same inspectable brief structure across accounts and users.

LAYER ADDED

Skill + template + output contract + QA + stop conditions

A skill is a small operating manual for an agent.



ABM Strategist turns evidence into an approval-ready account campaign brief.

Fix the shared process once. Every future run starts stronger.

Verify, interpret, qualify, then draft.

1 VERIFY | HIRING SIGNAL VERIFICATION

Peter S. Borkovich | T3 synthetic + T4 live read-only

2 INTERPRET | Signal Interpreter | Din Arbel

T3 synthetic | meaning + confidence + why-now | no routing or writes

3 QUALIFY | AUDIENCE ICP FILTER

Erwann Lefevre | T3 synthetic | Keep / Exclude / Review

4 DRAFT | Multichannel Campaign Builder | Erwann Lefevre

T3 conditional synthetic | source-backed inputs + mandatory human QA

LEVEL 2 TO 3 SOURCE BRIDGE

Company Deep Dive | Uriel Knorovich | T1 static only | source hierarchy, dated claims, contradictions, refresh deduplication

22 ICP records reconciled | 45/45 checks | hiring audit: 2 accepted, 4 narrowed, 5 dropped

External community work. Teaching references only. No Swan packages in the live build or external actions from these examples.

Level 4: Governed Automation

INPUT

Every Monday, check approved Alder sources. If material evidence changed, rerun the skills, update the brief, show the diff, and route exceptions. Do not publish or send.

OUTPUT

Updated brief
Diff
No-change record
Exception queue
Audit trail

A good workflow records no change when the evidence does not justify a change.

LAYER ADDED

Trigger + state + routing + retries + monitoring

A cron job IN a trench coat

Do not dress up a brittle automation and call it an agent.

AUTOMATION

Predetermined path and tools

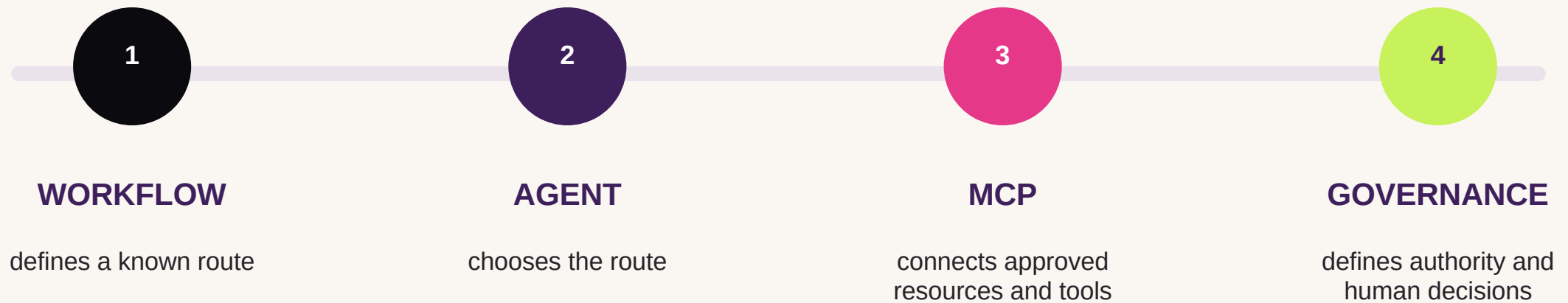
AGENT

Goal, dynamic planning, and tool choice

Useful automation is still useful. Fake sophistication is the problem.



Workflow, agent, MCP, and governance solve different problems.



MCP gives access. It does not give judgment or permission.

Level 5: Goal-Driven Agent System

I GIVE YOU TEXT,
YOU GIVE ME AN ANSWER



I GIVE YOU A GOAL,
YOU PRODUCE THE OUTCOME

INPUT

Increase qualified engagement across North Peak's top industrial AI accounts. Decide which accounts need research, a refreshed brief, a personalized experience, or no action. Request approval before activation.

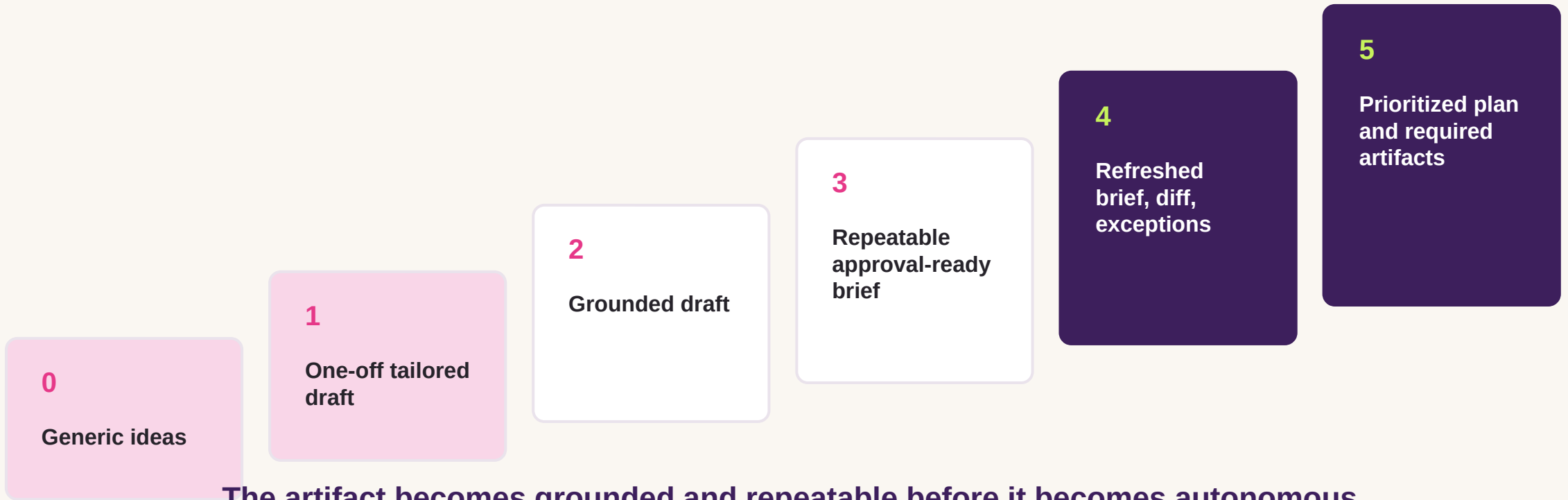
OUTPUT

A prioritized plan and the right mix of research, briefs, experiences, and next actions.

LAYER ADDED

Goals + planning + tool choice + evaluation + interrupt controls

Keep one ABM campaign current across all six levels.



The artifact becomes grounded and repeatable before it becomes autonomous.

Measure outcomes, not AI activity.

SPEED

QUALITY

CONSISTENCY

CAMPAIGN VOLUME

PERSONALIZATION

When the system runs without direct supervision, also track corrections, exceptions, failed runs, stale sources, unsupported claims, overrides, and cost per approved outcome.

Most teams should focus here.



YOUR STARTER KIT

North Peak company brain
Context Corpus Builder
ABM Strategist
30-day upgrade plans

Level 4 to 5 needs a one-to-one architecture session around your systems, data, permissions, and failure tolerance.

Live build: fresh workspace to grounded ABM system

1

Open a fresh Claude Code workspace through ForgeX

2

Bring in the ForgeX repository

3

Inspect safety, North Peak context, and ABM Strategist

4

Run the Level 3 Alder prompt

5

Review evidence, gaps, approvals, and the Level 4 extension

15
MINUTES

Leave with one repeated job you are ready to move up one level.